



INTRODUCTION TO ISLAM

FACULTY OF ISLAMIC STUDIES

GENERAL EDUCATION

DIHPE - DOW UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES (DUHS)

Topic # I

Lecture # III

Hadith and Sunnah

(Compilation, Classification and Significance)

HADITH

- A hadith is a report of the sayings or actions of Prophet Muhammad (SAW) together with the list of its chain of narration.
- Hadith refers to those sayings, actions, and approvals attributed to Rasulullah (SAW), the Sahabah, or the Tabieen.
 - Allah states in Holy Quran, (Al' Quran 53:3-4)
“And he (the Prophet Muhammad (SAW) does not speak out of his own desire. It is not but a revelation revealed (to him).”
- The words "Khabar" and "Athar" are synonyms for the word “Hadith.”

TERM	MEANING IN ARABIC	USAGE IN HADITH TERMINOLOGY	EXAMPLE
KHABAR	Report / Information	Used for Hadith — statements or actions directly from the Prophet (PBUH)	Sahih Hadith: Narrated by Abu Hurairah (RA): The Prophet (PBUH) said, <i>“Actions are judged by intentions.”</i> (Sahih Bukhari)
ATHAR	Trace / Effect	Used for statements or actions of Companions (Sahabah) or Successors (Tabi‘een)	Hazrat Ali ibn Abi Talib (RA) said, <i>“A person is hidden under his tongue.”</i> (Ibn Abi Shaybah, authentic Athar)

PROPHET'S (SAW) HADITH

- The 'Hadith' is derived from 'Tahdis', meaning to inform.
- The word Hadith means news, report or narration.
- In Islamic terminology, the term hadith refers to the sayings, actions and tacit approval of Holy Prophet (SAW) for any action.
- In technical terms Hadith stands for the report of words and deeds, approval or disapproval of Rasulullah (SAW).
- Whatever Rasulullah (SAW) said or did constitute the Hadith.
- If someone said or did something in presence of Rasulullah (SAW) and he approved or disapproved those words or deeds is also included in the definition of Hadith.
- He told us how to interact with other people, how to behave with other people, how to eat, drink, sleep, etc.

PROPHET'S (SAW) SUNNAH

- The dictionary meaning of Sunnat is method.
 - In Arabic, Sunnah means a practice, path, way, or mode of conduct. The word is used for a manner, rule of conduct, way of life, or established practice.
 - As as a term in Islamic jurisprudence (Shariat). It means the method of Holy Prophet (SAW).
 - The Holy Prophet (SAW) showed us how to live in this world and how to interact with it without allowing worldly life to dominate our hearts. The Sunnah reflects the teachings and practices of the Holy Prophet (SAW).
- “Whatever Rasulullah (SAW) did or said, was all under the Divine Guidance and Control. In other words, we can say that Hadith is a Divine Word but indirectly as compared to the Qur'an which is directly a Divine word”.

- Whatever the Messenger of Allah (SAW) said or did in matters of religion was guided by Allah's revelation.
- However, Hadith is not the direct Word of Allah like the Qur'an.
 - The Qur'an is the direct Word of Allah, while Hadith records the sayings, actions, approvals, and descriptions related to the Prophet (SAW).

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN HADITH & SUNNAH

- Sunnah refers to the traditions, practices, and way of life of the Holy Prophet (SAW), which serve as a role model for Muslims to follow.
- Hadith refers to the recorded narrations and reports of the sayings, actions, and approvals of the Holy Prophet (SAW).
- Hadith preserves and documents the Sunnah.
- Although the terms are sometimes used interchangeably, Hadith refers to the recorded reports, while Sunnah refers to the broader practice and example of the Prophet's (SAW) way of life derived from these reports.
- Along with the Qur'an, the Sunnah and Hadith are fundamental sources for understanding and applying Islamic teachings and Shariah.
- The Qur'an is the direct Word of Allah, while the Sunnah was guided by Divine Revelation and provides detailed guidance for Muslim life.

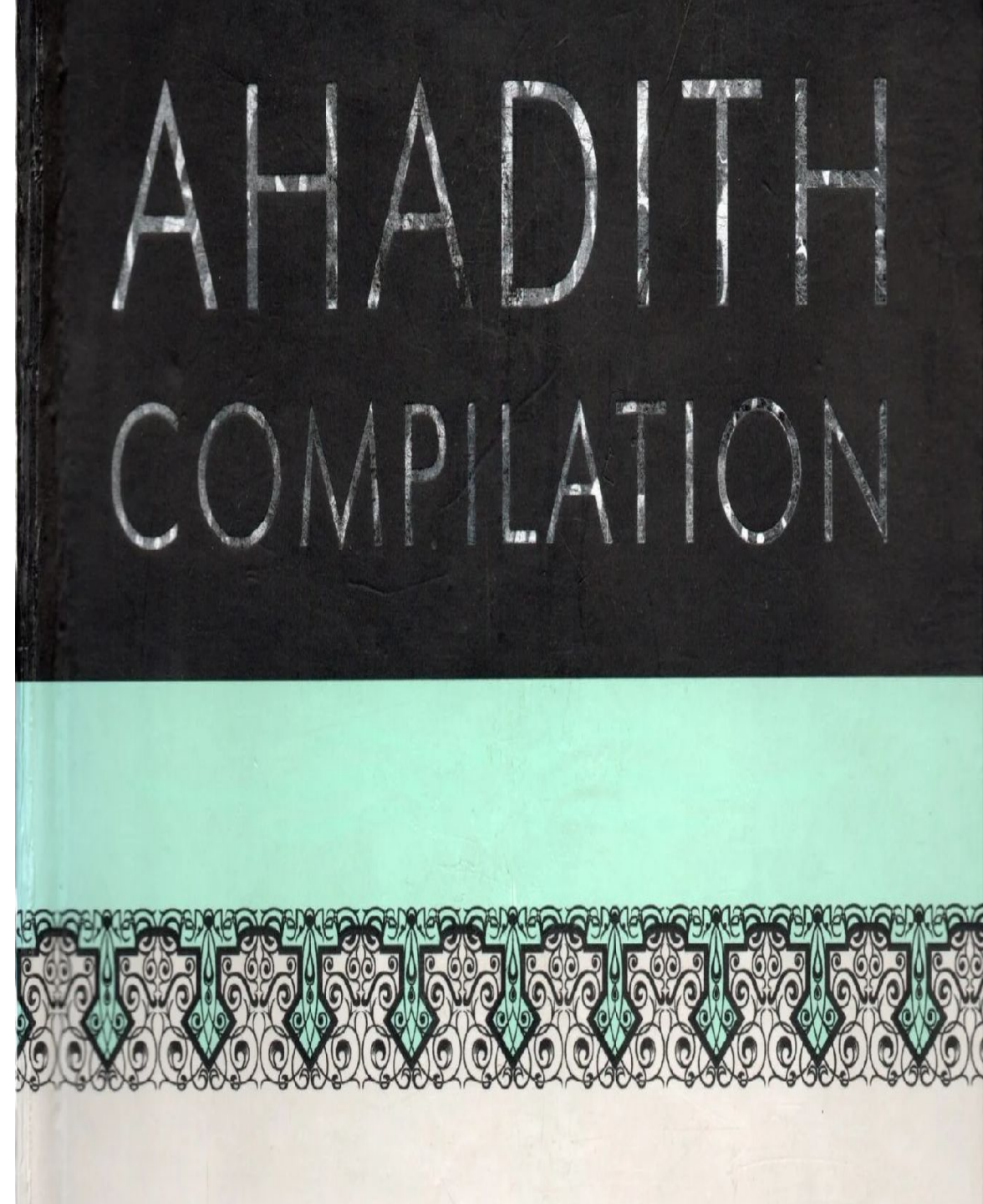
SURAH AL-IMRAN, AYAT 31

قُلْ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ اللَّهَ فَاتَّبِعُونِي يُحْبِبْكُمُ اللَّهُ وَيَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ ذُنُوبَكُمْ
وَاللَّهُ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ ﴿٣١﴾

- ❖ 'O beloved! Say you, 'O people! If you love Allah, then follow me; Allah will love you and forgive your sins and Allah is Forgiving, Merciful.

COMPILATION OF HADITH

- The first stage relates to the period of the Prophet (SAW) till 10 A.H.
- The second stage is approximately from 11 A.H. to 100 A.H. This is the period of Sahaba, the companions of the Prophet (SAW).
- The third stage is from about 101 to nearly 200 A.H. This is the period of the Tabi'in, the followers of the companions of the Prophet (SAW).
- The fourth stage is roughly from 200 A.H. to 300 A.H. This is the period of Taba Tabiun, the followers of the followers.



COMPILATION DURING LIFE OF HOLY PROPHET (PBUH):

- Like the Holy Quran, word and acts of the Holy Prophets (PBUH) were also preserved by his Companions. Companions of the Holy Prophet (PBUH) gave extreme importance and value to the Holy Prophet's (PBUH) saying and deeds because Almighty Allah said in the Holy Quran,
- ❖ “He (Prophet Muhammad SAW) does not speak out of his own wish but what it is revealed upon him (from Allah).’ (53:3-4)
- Holy Prophet (PBUH) himself would give instructions about the transmission of what he taught, “Preach what you hear me say. Also let those who see and hear me, take upon themselves to communicate my words to others and preach to their children, relatives and friends.”

- The companions had three methods of learning or preservation of the Hadith; **memorization, writing and practice**.
- There is another report according to which on the Farewell Pilgrimage, the Holy Prophet (SAW) said,
 - ❖ “He who is present here should carry this message to him who is absent.”
- At Madina the Holy Prophet himself appointed some persons to acquire knowledge of Islam. These were called as Ashabb-us-Suffah (the people of Bench).

COLLECTION AND COMPILATION AFTER THE DEATH OF HOLY PROPHET (PBUH)

- After the Demise of Holy Prophet (SAW) , Islam was widely spread, new converts wanted to hear about Holy Prophet (SAW) from close companions and associates.
- The companions were the best authority for Knowledge of ahadis and sunnah as they had listened to Prophet(SAW) Hazrat Abu Hurairah (RA), Hazrat Abudullah bin Abbas (RA), Hazrat Abdullah bin Umar (RA), Hazrat Anas bin Malik (RA) became the centre to whom people came from different parts of the Islamic empire to gain Knowledge about the Holy Prophet (SAW).

- Abdullah bin Umar (RA) began to write down whatever he heard from the Holy Prophet (PBUH) . His collections contained around 10,000 Ahadis. Abdullah bin Umar (RA) himself said: “I used to write everything that I heard from the Prophet (PBUH) intending to commit it to memory”. I spoke about it to the Holy prophet (PBUH) who said:
 - “Write down, for I only speak the truth” (Abu Daud)
 - Another report of Abu Hurairah (RA): ‘None of the companions preserved more traditions than myself , but Abdullah bin Umar is an exception for he used to write, and I did not’

- Hazrat Ali (RA) used to write down ahadis concerning the Orders, Instructions issued from Holy Prophet (PBUH).
- Hazrat Aisha (RA) also used to preserved the says of Holy Prophet (PBUH)
- Abdullah bin Umar (RA) and Abdullah bin Abbas(RA) were engaged in preserving and transmitting the ahadis.
- The Compilation of Abdullah bin Umar (RA) was known as Sadiqa. Process of compilation started in the Life of Holy Prophet (PBUH)

- Holy Prophet (SAW) wives were also vital custodians of Ahadis and were approached for instruction by other companions.
- Hazrat Aisha (RA), Hazrat Hafsa (RA), Hazrat umm-e- Habibah (RA) , Hazrat Maimunah (RA) and Hazrat Umme-e-Salamah (RA) are among the earliest and most distinguished transmitters.

Prominent compilations are :

- Sahifa e Sadiqa
(Hazrat Abdullah bin Amar)
- Saheefa e Ali (Hazrat Ali bin Abi Talib)
- Sahifa Anas bin Malik (Hazrat Anas bin Malik)
- Book of Saad
(Hazrat Saad bin Ubadah)
- Book of Jabir
(Hazrat Jabir bin Abdullah)

THE AGE OF COMPANION (11-100 AH)

- During this period the companions spread far and wide and settled in almost all the countries conquered by the Muslims. There was no book of compilation. The only alternative was to go to companion and hear the tradition from him.
- The important works of that period were:
- Ibn Shihab al-Zuhri (Madinah): Contributed significantly to the early systematic collection and compilation of Hadith.
- Imam al-Sha'bi (Kufa): Played an important role in transmitting and teaching Hadith.
- Imam Makhul (Sham): Contributed to the transmission and teaching of Hadith.
- Abu Bakr ibn Muhammad ibn Hazm (Madinah): Contributed to the early official compilation of Hadith during the caliphate of Umar ibn Abd al-Aziz.

THE AGE OF FOLLOWERS OF THE COMPANIONS (TABAEENS 101-200 AH)

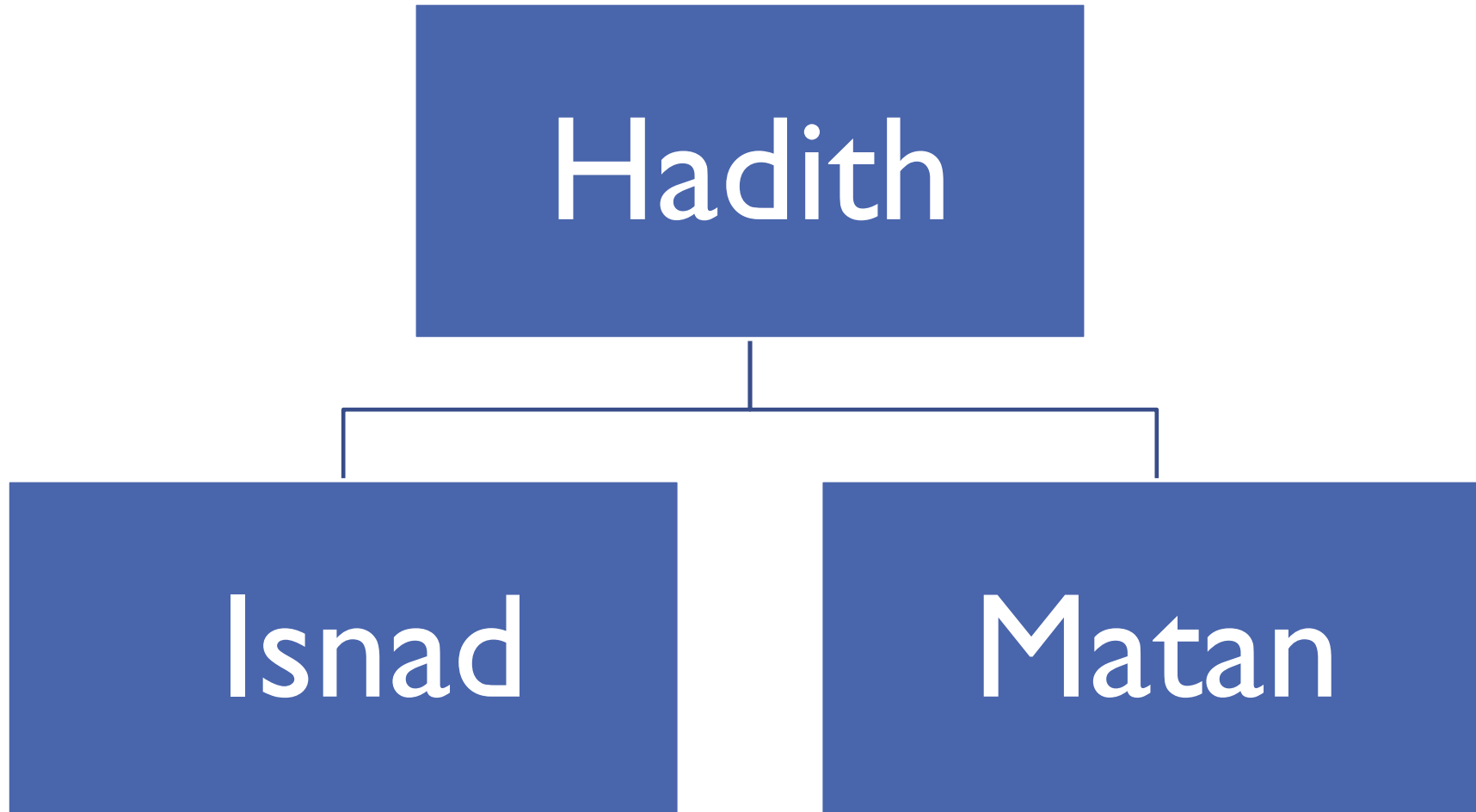
- This is the age of followers of the companions of the Holy Prophet (PBUH).
- **Formulation of Legal Schools:** Hanafi and Maliki schools based on Hadith.
- **Importance of Hadith in Legal Thought:** Shaping Islamic jurisprudence.

AGE OF FOLLOWERS OF THE FOLLOWERS (TABA TABAEEN 200-300 AH)

■ This is Golden age of Traditions. The six authentic books of traditions (Al Sahah –Al Sitta) were written. These are the most reliable books of traditions.

1. Sahih Bukhari by Imam Muhammad bin Ismail Bukhari (RA)
2. Sahih Muslim compiled by Imam Muslim bin Hajjaj (RA)
3. Jami Tirmidhi compiled by Imam abu Isa Tirmidhi (RA)
4. Sunan of Abu Daud compiled by Imam Abu Daud (RA)
5. Sunan of Nisai compiled by Imam Abu Abdur Rehman Ahmed Nisai (RA)
6. Sunan of ibn Majah compiled by Imam Abu Abdullah (RA).

STRUCTURE OF HADITH



- **Isnad/Sequence of Reporters**

A series of correspondents through which Hadith has spread. It is the chain of narrators of the hadith. It consists of all those who narrated the text. Starting from the last narrator and ending with the Holy Prophet (SAW).

- **Matan/Content**

It is the main passage which is the actual centre of attraction for the reader. It normally talks about the right way of actions in different circumstances of life.

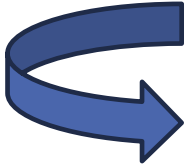
STRUCTURE OF HADITH

Sanad

- حدثنا الحميدى عبد الله بن الزبير قال حدثنا سفيان قال حدثنا يحيى بن سعيد الانصارى قال اخبرنا محمد بن ابراهيم التيمى انه سمع علقمة بن وقاص الليثى يقول سمعت عمر بن الخطاب رضى الله عنه

Matan

انما الاعمال بالنيات.



A SAHIH (AUTHENTIC) HADITH IS CHARACTERIZED BY FIVE KEY QUALITIES

Good Character and Reliability of Narrators: The narrators must be known for their honesty, trustworthiness, and piety.

Strong Memory and Precision of Narrators: Narrators should have a strong memory and the ability to accurately recall and transmit the hadith.

Continuous Isnaad: The chain of transmission (isnaad) must be unbroken, linking each narrator to the previous one, ultimately reaching the Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him).

Absence of Oddness or Contradiction: The hadith should not contain any unusual or contradictory elements in the isnaad or text that would undermine its authenticity.

Freedom from Subtle Faults or Defects: The hadith should be free from any subtle flaws or defects that could be detected only by experienced scholars of hadith.

CATEGORIES OF HADITH (FOR JUDGMENT OF RELIABILITY OF SANAD AND MATAN OF HADITH)

1. **SAHĪH (Authentic)** - transmitted through an unbroken chain of narrators all of whom are of sound character and memory.
2. **HASAN (Approved)** - transmitted through an unbroken chain of narrators all of whom are of sound character but weak memory.
3. **DHA'IF (Weak)** - which cannot gain the status of HASAN because it lacks one or more elements of a HASAN hadīth. For example, if the narrator is not of sound memory and sound character, or if there is a hidden fault in the narrative or if the chain of narrators is broken. Weak Hadith raise many questions about its authenticity.
4. **MAWDŪ'** - fabricated and wrongly ascribed to the Holy Prophet (*sallahu alaihe wasallam*)

DIVISION OF HADITH ON THE BASIS OF STRENGTH OF NARRATORS

- I. **Mutawatir:** Meaning “Consecutive” or “Continuous.” A Hadith transmitted by such a large number of narrators in each generation that it is impossible to think that they all conspired to fabricate it or agreed upon a lie. Thus, it provides certain knowledge and authenticity.

Example: The Prophet (SAW) said: “Whoever intentionally attributes a lie to me, let him prepare his seat in the Fire.” This Hadith is considered Mutawatir in wording (Lafzi) by many scholars.

- I. **Khabar-e-Wahid / Ahad:** Meaning “Isolated” or “Single.” A Hadith narrated by a limited number of narrators that does not reach the level of Mutawatir. It is further divided into Mashhur (three or more), ‘Aziz (at least two), and Gharib (one narrator at any level of the Isnad).

Example: The Prophet (SAW) said: “Actions are judged by intentions, and every person will have only what he intended.” — Sahih al-Bukhari, Sahih Muslim

DIVISION OF HADITH ON THE BASIS OF SANAD

According to the Authority to Whom the Hadith Is Attributed

According to careful research, Hadith is divided into four additional types under this category:

1. **Qudsi:** Meaning “Divine.” It is a Hadith in which the Prophet (SAW) conveys a meaning attributed to Allah. However, unlike the Qur’an, it is not considered the direct Word of Allah and is not recited as an act of worship.
2. **Marfu (Akhbar/Hadith-e-Nabwi):** Meaning “Elevated” or “Raised.” It is a narration attributed directly to the Holy Prophet (SAW), including his sayings, actions, approvals, or descriptions.
3. **Mauquf:** Meaning “Stopped.” It is a narration attributed to a Companion (Sahabi) rather than to the Holy Prophet (SAW), including the Companion’s sayings or actions.
4. **Maqtu (Aasar):** Meaning “Severed.” It is a narration attributed to a Successor (Tabi’i), including his sayings or actions.

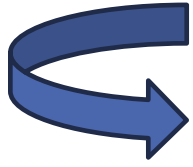
BASIC KINDS OF HADITH

There are three basic kinds of Hadith-e-Nabwi.

1. **Qawli Hadith** - what Prophet said and spoke himself.
2. **Fi'ali Hadith**- The action of Prophet what he performed and demonstrated.
3. **Taqriri Hadith**- which comes from Prophet silence regarding any action.

SIGNIFICANCE OF HADITH

- It provides real explanation of Quranic Verses.
- It clarifies difficult to understand parts of Quran.
- It provides detailed information about the brief reference in Quran.
- Its guides toward the practical application of the Verses of Quran.
- The Sunnah has close relationship with the Qur'an.
- It is a secondary and complementary to the Qur'an.
- Recourse to the Sunnah is required in case if the words of the Qur'an convey ambiguous meaning and have possibility of more than one meaning.
- Thus, the Sunnah plays significant role with respect to the Qur'an in explanation of legal rules.



HADITH GIVES TEACHINGS ON POINTS ABOUT WHICH THE QURAN HAS NOT SPOKEN

- The Quran repeatedly asks us:
- ❖ **“Establish regular prayer”**
 - without speaking about the number of raakats and manners in which it should be performed. Hadith of the Holy Prophet (SAW) explains it.
 - The Holy Prophet ((SAW) said,
 - **“The Messenger of Allah did not leave offering four rakats before the noon prayer.” [Bukhari]**
 - This Hadith confirms four rakaats for zuhar prayer.

SUNNAH OF THE HOLY PROPHET (SAW) PROVIDES PRACTICAL METHODS OF ISLAMIC PRACTICES

- The Quran enjoins us:
“Pilgrimage thereto is a duty men owe to Allah, those who can afford the journey”
- Full method of the Hajj is not mentioned in Quran. Sunnah of Holy Prophet (SAW) explains its performance.
- As it is said. Ibn Umar (RA) reported,
- **“The Holy Prophet (SAW) pronounced Talbiyah in Hajj and Umrah”**

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THANK YOU

Ms. Shumaila Farman

Lecturer (Islamiat)

GEP, DIHPE, DMC

Topic # I

Lecture # III

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shumaila.farman@duhs.edu.pk

